Leave policy template

Replace every [bracketed] item. Delete anything that does not apply to your organisation.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how [Company name] grants, records and approves leave for [all employees / list categories].

2. Leave types and entitlement

Leave type	Entitlement per [year]	How it is earned	Carry-forward	Notes
Casual leave	[__ days]	[Credited upfront / accrues monthly]	[Yes, up to __ days / No]	[Maximum days at a time]
Sick leave	[__ days]	[Credited upfront / accrues monthly]	[Yes / No]	[Certificate needed after __ days]
Earned (privilege) leave	[__ days]	[1 day per __ days worked]	[Up to __ days]	[Encashment: yes / no]
Statutory leave (for example maternity leave)	[As required by law]	[As required by law]	[As required by law]	[Refer to the applicable Act and rules]
Optional holidays / compensatory off	[__ days]	[Rule]	[Rule]	[Rule]
Leave without pay	[Rule]	Approval only	No	[Rule]

3. Requesting leave

Employees request leave through [system / form] at least [__ days] before the first day, except in an emergency.

In an emergency, inform [manager] as soon as possible and submit the request within [__ days].

4. Approval

The reporting manager approves or declines within [__ working days]. If the manager is away, [alternate approver] decides.

Declined requests include a short reason.

5. Documents

A [medical certificate] is required for sick leave longer than [__ days].

Other documents: [list].

6. Holidays and weekly offs

Public and optional holidays are published in [location] by [date] each year. Weekly offs: [days].

7. Carry-forward, lapse and encashment

Unused [leave type] lapses on [date] / carries forward up to [__ days].

Encashment: [rule, or "not applicable"].

8. Joining, probation and exit

Leave for employees joining part-way through the year is calculated [method].

Leave rules during probation: [rule]. Leave balance at exit: [rule].

9. Records

Leave balances and history are kept in [system]. Approved leave is reflected in attendance records.

10. Review

HR reviews this policy every [12 months]. Policy owner: [name, role]. Effective from: [date].

> General template for guidance only. Adapt it to your organisation and to the central and state rules that apply to you, and have it reviewed by a qualified professional before use.

Published by Onjaal. https://onjaal.com/resources/